PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, operating and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms at enterprise scale. I have led detection engineering initiatives, triaged and responded to complex security alerts, and built automated playbooks that have significantly reduced mean time to respond. I hold deep hands-on expertise with CrowdStrike Falcon (including Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Falcon Prevent, Insight and Discover) and Microsoft Sentinel, writing advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) detections and hunting queries across hybrid cloud environments. I thrive in fast-paced security operations centres, adapt quickly to shift patterns, and bring a strong understanding of the MITRE ATT&CK framework and NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle to every engagement.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk (SPL), IBM QRadar
- **SOAR and Automation:** CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Azure Logic Apps), PowerShell scripting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** KQL, CrowdStrike Query Language (CQL), MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detections, threat intelligence integration
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, digital forensics, containment and eradication
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Cloud and Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 Defender (MDE, MDI, Defender for Cloud Apps), Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other Tools:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead SIEM and SOAR operations across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, managing alert triage, detection rule tuning and automated response playbooks for an environment of over 8,000 users.
- Engineer and maintain detection content aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, writing advanced KQL and CQL queries to surface high-fidelity threats and reduce false positive volumes.
- Drive the full incident response lifecycle from initial alert triage through containment, eradication and post-incident review, following NIST 800-61 procedures.
- Develop and automate SOAR playbooks using CrowdStrike Fusion and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) by automating repetitive analyst tasks including account isolation, indicator enrichment and ticket creation.
- Collaborate with the threat intelligence team to integrate indicators of compromise (IOCs) and tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) into detection rules, strengthening proactive threat hunting capability.
- Conduct threat hunting exercises using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Discover, proactively identifying adversarial activity that evaded automated detections.

- Mentor junior security operations centre (SOC) analysts, running regular tabletop exercises and knowledge-sharing sessions on MITRE ATT&CK techniques and KQL query writing.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operated as a primary tier-two and tier-three analyst within the security operations centre, triaging SIEM alerts generated by Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon across a multi-cloud, hybrid Microsoft 365 environment.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Prevent across the full endpoint estate, achieving comprehensive coverage and enforcing Falcon policy baselines.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) identity security controls including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement and privileged identity management, reducing identity-based risk.
- Performed vulnerability management using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking remediation progress and reporting to management on critical and high-severity findings.
- Assisted in the design and implementation of SOAR automation workflows, cutting average alert handling time and enabling analysts to focus on high-value investigations.
- Supported Check Point Harmony firewall administration and Mimecast email security configuration, reducing phishing and malware delivery success rates.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification activities, ensuring technical controls met the required standard.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Delivered security engineering support across infrastructure and SaaS platform environments, including network security, endpoint hardening and identity management.
- Implemented and maintained security tooling for endpoint protection, vulnerability scanning and access management, supporting ISO 27001 compliance activities.
- Responded to security incidents and anomalous events, coordinating remediation with infrastructure and development teams.
- Supported quality and infrastructure projects, including cloud migration activities and IT service improvement initiatives.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user hybrid environment, achieving full endpoint visibility and enabling advanced threat hunting capability.
- Authored and tuned over 50 KQL-based Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and hunting queries aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, significantly improving signal-to-noise ratio within the security operations centre.
- Automated 15+ SOAR playbooks in CrowdStrike Fusion and Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to respond by an estimated 40% for common alert types including account compromise and malware execution.
- Led the successful deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across the full user estate, delivering comprehensive endpoint and identity threat detection coverage.
- Supported UAL's achievement and renewal of Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating compliance with UK Government security standards.
- Established a formal threat hunting programme using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying and neutralising persistent threats before they triggered automated alerts.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)